type. It differs from continental socialism in its total innocence of any Marxist links. The social democrats on the continent are all theoretically loyal to the pre-Leninist second international type of Marxism. Shirley Williams, David Owen and Roy Jenkins are all friendly to India and have a strong commitment to Europe. Their assumption of office would be, from our point of view, a positive development.

Although the Indian government headed by Prime Minister Indira Gandhi enjoyed an excellent personal equation with Margaret Thatcher, the agency's job was to warn the leader to not put all the country's eggs in one basket, but placate influential figures across the spectrum. Indira acted on the advice. She developed good relationships with both Shirley Williams and Roy Jenkins, the founding members of the SDP. According to a R&AW analyst, the change in British politics indicated a massive shift in the political dynamics of Europe which created modern mainstream parties and junked class as the basis for politics. The R&AW analysis observed:

The Labour Party, in its new left-wing policies, would not stray away from the mainstream, even though it will make maximum tactical use of differences at home. The victory of President Mitterand and continuing viability of the S.P.D. in Germany have to be seen against the comparative success of the minor Italian Socialist party in influencing national politics. We have to also take into account the de-facto convergence between continental socialism and the communist parties of Italy and Spain. Then, there is the crucial role played by the socialists in Spain and Portugal. If the results of the next general election in Britain are ambiguous, there is theoretical possibility of the social democrats widening the support from the right-wing in